

Current Affairs 18-05-2026

Credit - Drishti Ias

India Re-included in EU's List for Aquaculture Export



Source: PIB

India has been re-included in the **European Union** 's revised draft list for continued export of aquaculture products, ensuring uninterrupted seafood flow to one of its largest global markets. It addresses the previous exclusion of India in **Implementing Regulation (EU) 2024/2598** .

- **Regulatory Compliance:** The re-inclusion follows India's strict adherence to **Delegated Regulation (EU) 2023/905** , which mandates that animal products must be free from **antimicrobials used for growth promotion** or those reserved for **human treatment** .
- India's compliance is supported by robust systems like the **National Residue Control Programme (NRCP)** and the **Post Harvest Testing Programme** , which monitor for banned antibiotics and pharmacologically active substances.
- The development also recognises sustained efforts undertaken by the Department of Commerce through organisations such as the **Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA)** and the **Export Inspection Council (EIC)** to strengthen regulatory compliance and promote **responsible aquaculture practices** .
- **Economic Significance:** The EU is India's **3 rd -largest seafood market** , accounting for **18.94% of total export value (USD 1.593 billion)** in 2025–26, with **farmed shrimp** remaining the primary export commodity.

Aquaculture Scenario in India

- **Global & Economic Standing:** India is the **2 nd largest fish-producing nation** in the world after China, accounting for approximately **8% of global output** . The fisheries sector accounts for nearly **7.43%** of the **Agricultural Gross Value Added (GVA)** .
 - Seafood exports reached a record **Rs 62,408 crore** in FY 2024–25. **Frozen shrimp** remains the dominant export item, with high demand from the US and China.
- **Production Dynamics:** India's fish production **nearly doubled** over the last decade, reaching **197.75 lakh tonnes** in 2024–25. Inland production now accounts for roughly **75%** of total fish production.
 - **Andhra Pradesh** is the largest producer followed by **West Bengal** , **Uttar Pradesh** , and **Gujarat** .
- **Key Government Schemes:** **Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana** , **Fisheries & Aquaculture Infrastructure Development Fund** , **Pradhan Mantri Matsya Kisan Samridhi Sah Yojana** etc.

Read More: [India's Fisheries Sector](#)

Singapore as India's 2nd-Largest Export Market



Source: IE

The prolonged **West Asia war** has significantly altered India's trade and energy supply chains, with **Singapore overtaking UAE as India's second-largest export destination** amid severe disruptions in Gulf trade routes. The **US remains India's largest export destination**.

- **Geopolitical Disruption in Trade:** The blockage of the **Strait of Hormuz** (a critical maritime choke point between Iran and Oman) has forced Indian traders to find alternative logistics routes, severely disrupting traditional trade with the West Asia region.
 - The Strait previously accounted for a **fifth of global oil flows**.
- **Surge in Singapore Exports:** Leveraging its status as a transshipment hub and its **Free Trade Agreement (FTA)** with India, exports to **Singapore surged by 180%**.
 - Conversely, exports to the UAE (another major FTA partner) dropped by 36%. **Diversification of Energy Imports:** With traditional Middle Eastern supplies restricted, India has diversified its crude sourcing, bringing nations like **Oman, Peru, and Nigeria** into its top 20 import sources.
- **Macroeconomic Strain on India:** The global energy supply crisis has **widened India's import bill** and severely impacted the currency, causing the **Indian rupee to fall to multiple record lows** (depreciating by 5.2% against the US dollar since February 2026).
 - To manage foreign exchange reserves and limit fuel consumption, the government has hiked the **import duty on precious metals** and allowed oil marketing companies to increase retail petrol and diesel prices for the first time in four years.

India- Singapore Trade and Economic Cooperation

- **Trade Dynamics:** Driven by the **Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement (CECA)**, bilateral trade expanded dramatically from USD 6.7 billion in FY 2004-05 to **USD 34.3 billion in 2024-25**, solidifying Singapore as India's **6th largest trading partner**.
 - Singapore stands as India's **largest source of FDI** (USD 14.94 billion in FY 2024-25).
- **Institutional Frameworks:** To actively facilitate cross-border capital, **Invest India opened a dedicated office in Singapore** in September 2024, complemented by the **Singapore Business Federation** establishing its maiden Indian office in Bengaluru in November 2025.
- **Pioneering Fintech Integration:** Bilateral financial infrastructure achieved a global benchmark via the **UPI-PayNow Linkage**, establishing India's **first operational cross-border Person-to-Person (P2P) payment facility**.
- **Digital Commerce and Trade Finance:** Strategic collaborations include the **ONDC-Proxtera Connectivity** for international retail applications, the **GIFT Connect** linkage (unifying liquidity pools between NSE and SGX for NIFTY products), and the **TradeTrust** architecture enabling interoperable **electronic Bills of Lading (eBLs)**.



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